

Thooval Studios

AI assisted dubbing and subtitling for Indian language streaming

Seed round, July 2026

Kozhikode, Kerala

The problem

- A Malayalam series that would work in Tamil usually never gets dubbed.
- Traditional dubbing costs about Rs 1.4 lakh a finished hour and takes 6 to 9 days.
- So platforms dub only their biggest titles and the back catalogue sits unwatched.
- The content already exists. The economics of translating it do not.

What we do

- Rs 38,000 a finished hour, delivered in 31 hours, across nine Indian languages.
- Synthesis does the first pass. A dubbing director and a voice artist do the last one.
- The voice artist is paid, credited and holds a royalty. That is not optional for us.
- 4,180 hours delivered to four OTT platforms and eleven production houses.

Why the last pass matters

- A pure machine dub is detectably wrong within about forty seconds.
- Lip sync fails on plosives, and emotion collapses in an argument scene.
- Our director marks the scenes that need a human take, usually 12 to 18 percent.
- That is the whole difference between a demo and something a platform will publish.

Traction

- ARR of Rs 1.64 crore in July 2026, up from Rs 89 lakh in February.
- 868 hours delivered in July alone.
- 13 of 17 customers have come back for a second title.
- Nine languages live, from an initial five.

Why voice artists work with us

- 90 artists on panel, every one under a consent and royalty agreement.
- They earn on the first dub and again every time their voice model is reused.
- An artist can withdraw consent for any title or any language at any time.
- This is why we have a panel at all. The industry is watching how this is done.

Unit economics

- Rs 38,000 revenue a finished hour, Rs 14,500 gross contribution.
- Voice artist fees and royalty are Rs 11,200 of that, and we do not intend to cut it.
- Compute is Rs 2,100 a hour, which is noise next to the creative cost.
- A traditional studio makes Rs 26,000 a hour on Rs 1.4 lakh. We make more on less.

Market

- Indian OTT localisation spend is estimated at over Rs 1,400 crore a year and growing.
- Every regional platform has a back catalogue it cannot afford to translate.
- Education publishers are a second market we did not plan for and now serve.
- Kozhikode gives us a creative talent pool at a fraction of Mumbai cost.

Use of funds

- Rs 6.5 crore, expected to last 16 months.
- Rs 2.2 crore: three more language pairs and the voice model work behind them.
- Rs 1.8 crore: studio capacity, a second mixing suite in Kozhikode.
- Rs 1.6 crore: sales into Mumbai and Hyderabad platform teams.
- Rs 0.9 crore: reserve.

The team

- Rahul Panicker, CEO. Nine years in post production, ran localisation delivery for three OTT platforms.
- Divya Krishnan, CTO. Published on low resource Indian language speech synthesis.
- Ameer Haris, Creative. Dubbing director on fourteen feature releases.
- 22 full time, plus 90 voice artists on panel.